

ROBERT KOCH

German microbiologist
1843–1910



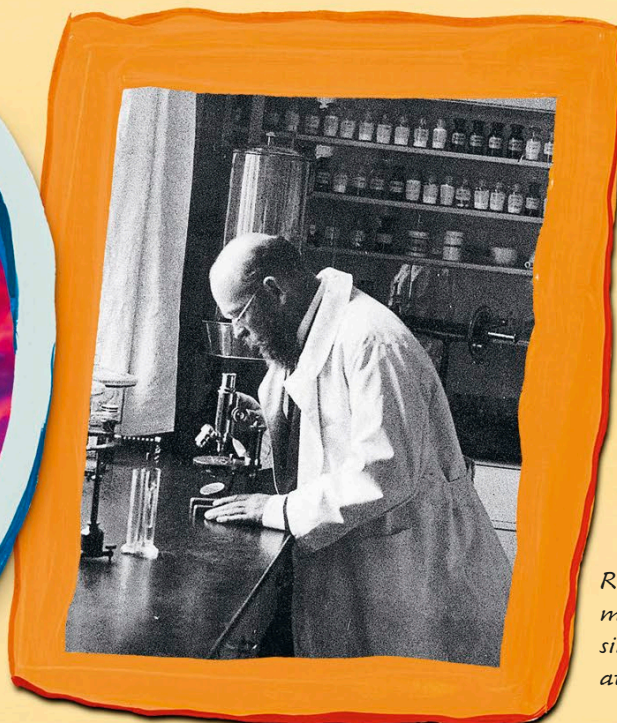
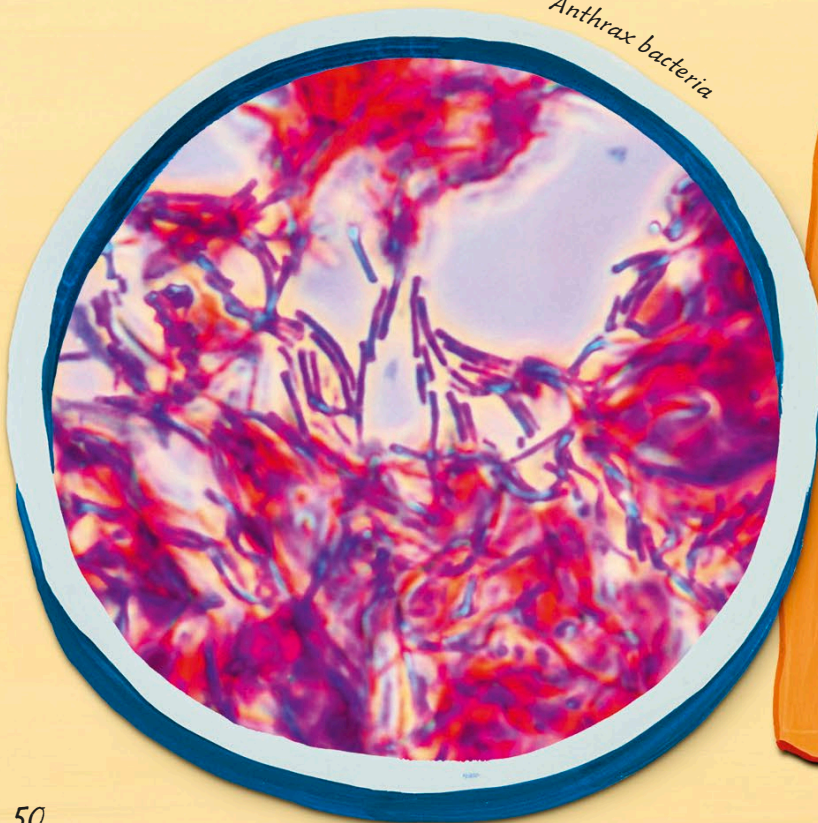
As a doctor in the 1800s, Robert Koch saw patient after patient battling deadly infections, such as tuberculosis, cholera, and diphtheria. Scientists had found clues that infectious diseases were caused by tiny, harmful microbes, or germs, but no one knew why there were so many different types of illness, seemingly caused by the same thing. Robert decided to try to solve the puzzle himself.

He began by looking at a disease called anthrax, which affected many farm animals in Germany at the time. Robert spotted the same, rod-shaped germs in the blood of different animals infected with the disease.

Staining bacteria

Robert invented new ways to study the tiniest living things. He let bacteria multiply in Petri dishes and stained them to show up better under a microscope. He realized that two species of bacteria can be as different as lions and sea stars!

Anthrax bacteria



Robert studied microbes using simple equipment at home.